SONG FORM

Pacing guide · 4 days

PACING

Teacher

Four class periods of about 53 minutes: a listening day, a planning and building day, a day to differentiate the sections, then finishing and presenting. Each day's full plan is on pages 7–8.

DAY	FOCUS AND GOAL	MINUTE BLOCKS	DECK
DAY 1 Learning	**Song form analysis: a listening day** All four Song Form sheets complete. Written response answered. Students have the vocabulary and structural intuition to plan their own form.	0–12 · Hook + class example 1 12–25 · Class example 2 25–45 · Independent analysis 45–53 · Share-out	Intro deck slides 1–7
DAY 2 Work day	**Plan + build the skeleton** Planning table complete, melody added, arrangement skeleton built with a marker on every section.	0–5 · Chord layer demo 5–12 · The project 12–25 · Plan + melody 25–50 · Build the skeleton 50–53 · Save + note	Intro deck slides 8–16
DAY 3 Work day	**Differentiate the sections** Chord layer added, melody placed on purpose, a drum transition at every section change; verse and chorus clearly different.	0–5 · The mute test 5–45 · Differentiate 45–53 · Play-through	No slides
DAY 4 Finish + present	**Finish, submit, present** Every project submitted and presented; every student can point to the chorus and say why it feels bigger.	0–20 · Finish + submit 20–50 · Presentations 50–53 · Close	Intro deck slide 17

STUDENT PAGES BY DAY ·

Day 1	Day 1 post (p. 13), Song Form sheets (pp. 18–20), Compare the forms and written response (p. 21)
Day 2	Project sheet (pp. 14–15), planning table (p. 16), steps (p. 17)
Day 3	Steps 4–5 (p. 17), vocabulary (p. 22)
Day 4	Submission checklist (p. 23), rubric for self-score and teacher score (p. 24)

THREE DAYS INSTEAD OF FOUR

My Teacher Notes run this unit in 3 days: Day 1 as here; Day 2 plans and builds, adds the chord layer and starts the transitions; Day 3 gives 20 minutes to finish and submit, then presentations. The four-day plan keeps the same blocks and gives building its own day.

PREVIEW

SONG FORM

Project sheet · plan your song form

STUDENT

Name _____ Date _____

Fill this in before you open Logic. Every section needs a job, a length, and a plan for what is playing.

MY KEY

- ☐ C major
- ☐ A minor
- ☐ **Other:** _____

CHORD PROGRESSION (ROMAN NUMERALS)

[ ] – [ ] – [ ] – [ ]

SECTION	BARS	ELEMENTS PLAYING chords / bass / melody / drums / chord layer	TRANSITION INTO NEXT SECTION
INTRO			
VERSE 1			
CHORUS 1			
VERSE 2			
CHORUS 2			
BRIDGE (OPTIONAL)			
OUTRO			

Each section at least 4 measures. Transitions: fill, breakdown, cut or build. Worked example: page 26.

PREVIEW

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SONG FORM

Song Form in pop music

Name _____ Date _____

Songs 1 and 2: we do these together. Listen, raise your hand at each section change, then label the sections and count the measures as a class.

SONG 1 · CRAZY

Gnarls Barkley AS A CLASS

#	SECTION	MEASURES	WHAT'S PLAYING · WHAT CHANGED
1	*Intro*		
2	*Verse*		
3	*Chorus*		
4	*Verse*		
5	*Chorus*		
6	*Verse*		
7	*Chorus*		
8	*Outro*		
9			
10			
11			
12			
13			
14			
15			

SONG 2 · BLINDING LIGHTS

The Weeknd AS A CLASS

#	SECTION	MEASURES	WHAT'S PLAYING · WHAT CHANGED
1	*Intro (Pop Drop)*		
2	*Verse*		
3	*Pre-chorus*		
4	*Chorus*		
5	*Pop Drop*		
6			
7			
8			
9			
10			
11			
12			
13			
14			
15			

Grey labels were filled in for you. For each section: name it, count the measures, and write what is playing or what changed (what came in, what dropped out).

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SONG FORM

Rubric

RUBRIC

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

Score each category from 2 to 5. Score yourself first, then your teacher scores.

Category	2	3	4	5	Self	Teacher
SONG FORM ANALYSIS	Fewer than two spreadsheets completed. Sections not labeled or measures not counted. Written response missing.	All four spreadsheets complete but with labeling errors or missing measure counts. Written response is vague.	All four spreadsheets complete and mostly accurate. Written response identifies at least one pattern across songs.	All four spreadsheets complete and accurate. Written response shows genuine insight about how song structure works across different songs.		
SONG FORM STRUCTURE	Fewer than 3 sections built. No arrangement markers. No clear structural plan evident.	At least 3 sections but some are unlabeled or too short. Planning table not completed before building.	At least 4 labeled sections, each at least 4 measures. Planning table completed. Intro, verse, and chorus all present.	Form is well-constructed and clearly planned. All required sections present. Structure feels like a complete song with a beginning, middle, and end.		
SECTION DIFFERENTIATION	All sections sound the same. No meaningful difference in texture or elements between sections.	Some difference between sections but verse and chorus are not clearly distinct. Layering absent or ineffective.	Verse and chorus clearly different. At least one chord layer added on a second instrument. Melody placement is intentional.	Multiple sections have distinct textures. Addition and removal of elements is deliberate. Listener can identify the section by ear without looking at the screen.		
ARRANGEMENT AS MIX	No evidence of mix decisions tied to arrangement. All elements at equal volume throughout with no change between sections.	Some volume awareness but mix does not meaningfully reflect arrangement. Dense and sparse sections feel similar in the mix.	Mix reflects the arrangement plan. Denser sections are fuller and louder. Sparse sections have room and clarity.	Arrangement and mix work as one. Every addition and removal of an element is audible and intentional. Nothing is clipping.		
DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION	Project not submitted or not presented.	Project submitted late or named incorrectly. Minimal presentation engagement.	Project named correctly and submitted. Presentation made. Feedback questions posted.	Project correctly named, on time. Student explains form and arrangement choices clearly, referencing specific sections. Three thoughtful feedback questions posted.		
				TOTAL	**/ 25**	**/ 25**

MY CHORUS IS BIGGER BECAUSE...

_____

_____

TEACHER COMMENTS

_____

_____

PREVIEW

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